2.16 Enteral Tube Feeding

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Family says he coughs during meals **Objective** • Coughs and chokes when eating or drinking • Failed the swallow screen	**ACTUAL** **Impaired swallowing** related to neuromuscular impairment as evidenced by coughing and choking during oral intake.	Gets enough nutrition through the feeding tube, without aspiration.	• Nothing by mouth until his swallow has been assessed. • Confirm the tube position before every use, following policy. • Run the feed at the prescribed rate. • Refer to the speech therapist.	Feed tolerated, weight steady: **goal met**.
Subjective • Complains of abdominal cramps **Objective** • Loose stools 4 times a day • Feeding began 2 days ago	**ACTUAL** **Diarrhea** related to enteral feeding intolerance as evidenced by frequent loose stools.	Stools formed again within 48 hours.	• Check the rate and strength of the feed. • Keep the feeding sets clean and change them as policy says. • Go over his medications with the physician. • Keep track of fluid balance.	Stools formed: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Fed by nasogastric tube • Less alert than normal	**RISK** **Risk for aspiration** as evidenced by risk factors: enteral feeding and decreased level of consciousness.	No aspiration.	• Head of the bed at 30–45 degrees during the feed and for 1 hour after. • Check where the tube is. • Measure gastric residual volume if ordered. • If he vomits or coughs, stop the feed.	Chest sounds clear: **goal met**.